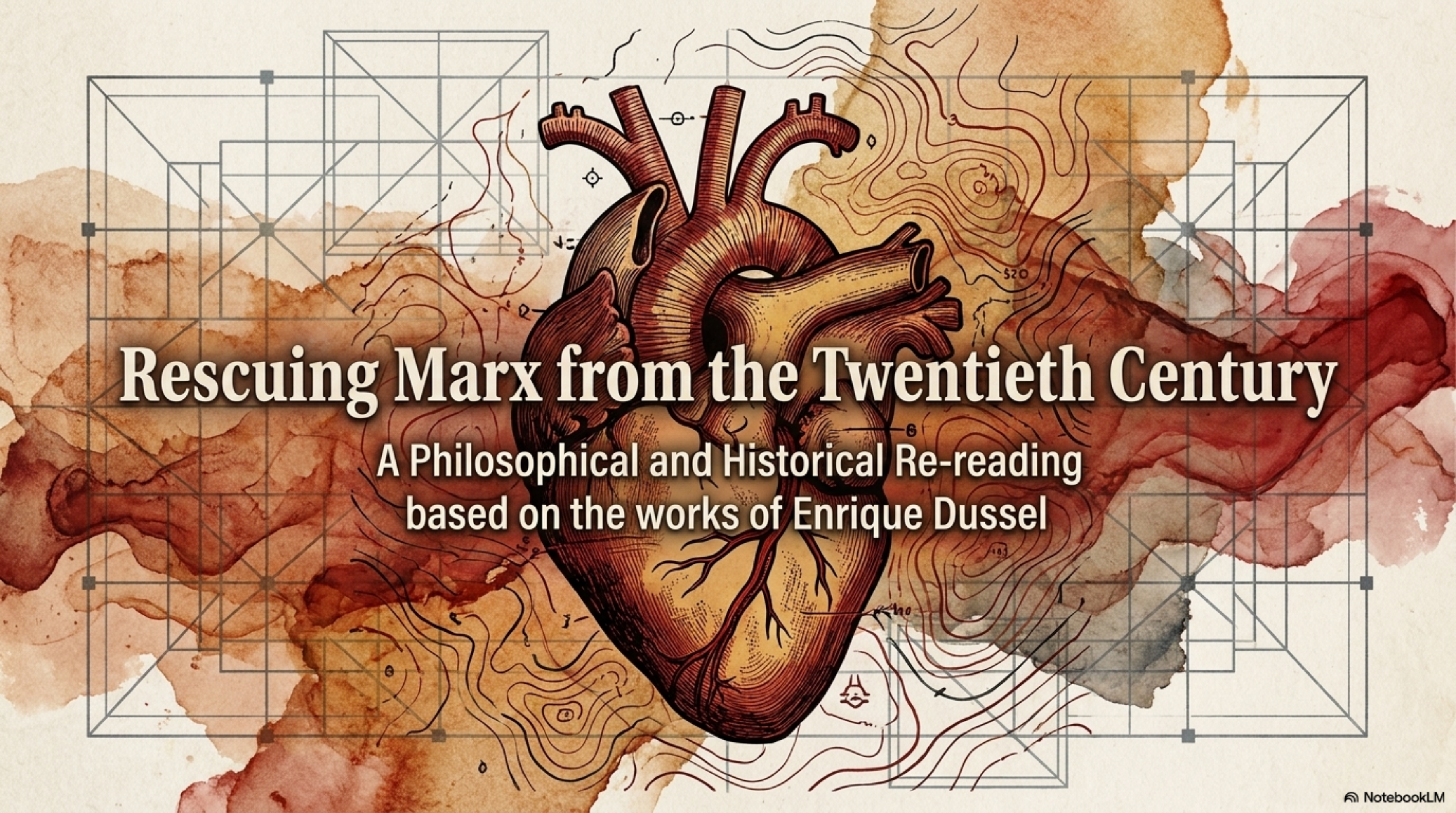




Rescuing Marx from the Twentieth Century

A Philosophical and Historical Re-reading
based on the works of Enrique Dussel



The Triumphalist Narrative

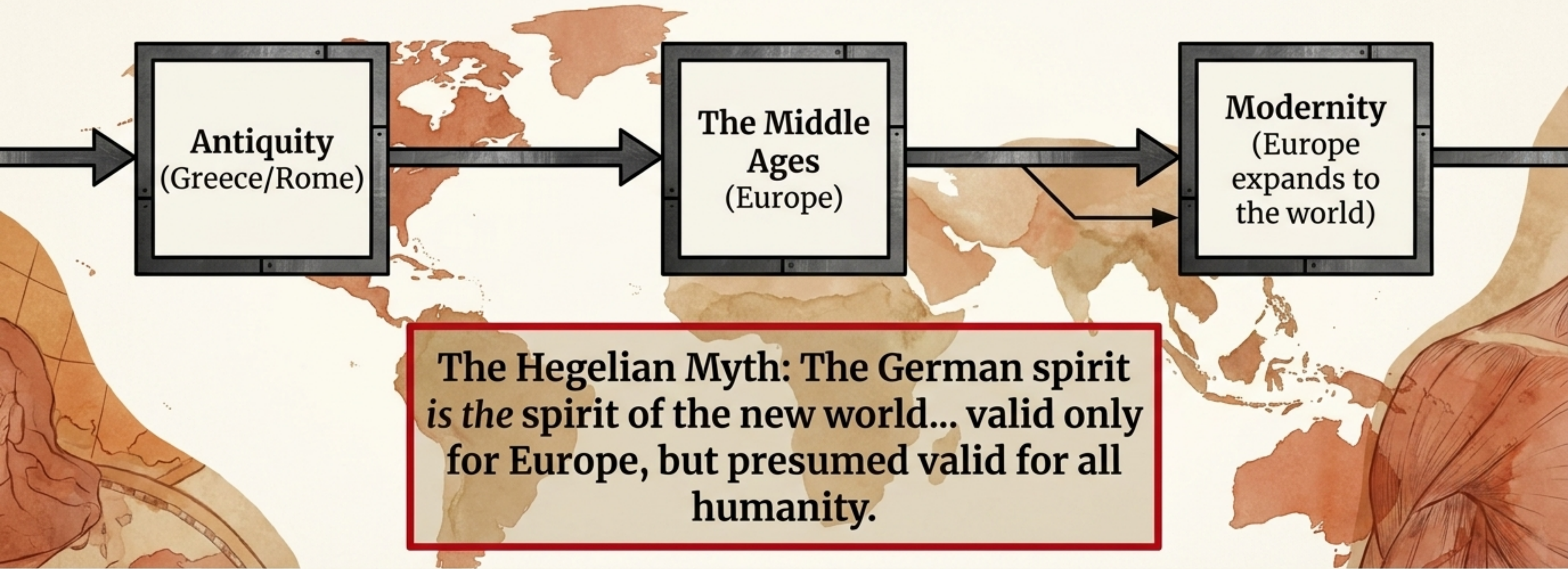
After 1989, neoliberalism claimed definitive victory. Marx's critique was buried under the assumption that the market was the final stage of human evolution.



The Theoretical Void

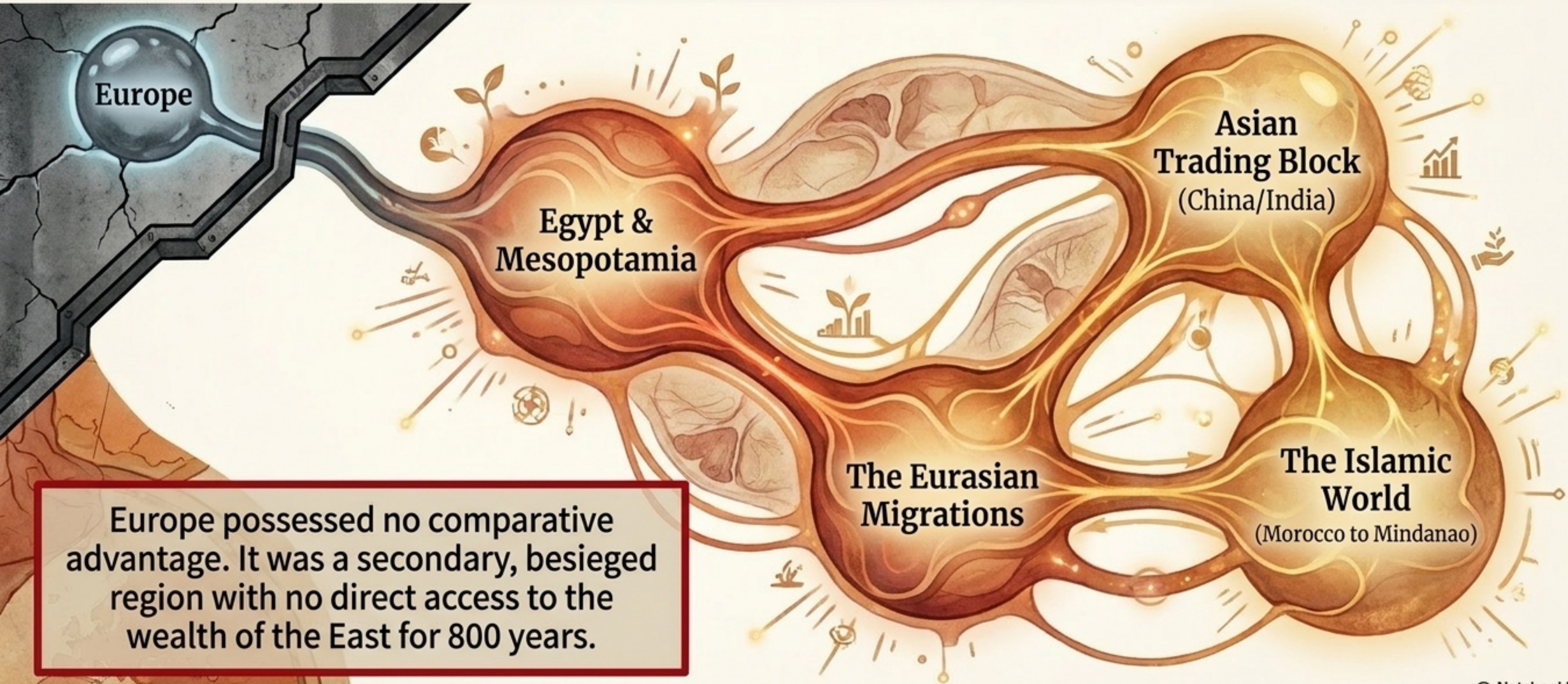
Without Marx's categorical framework, critical theory was left disarmed—unable to fundamentally question the structure of late capitalism.

The illusion of a linear, European-centered history



This timeline assumes Europe was always the absolute center of human development, rendering the rest of the globe an invisible periphery.

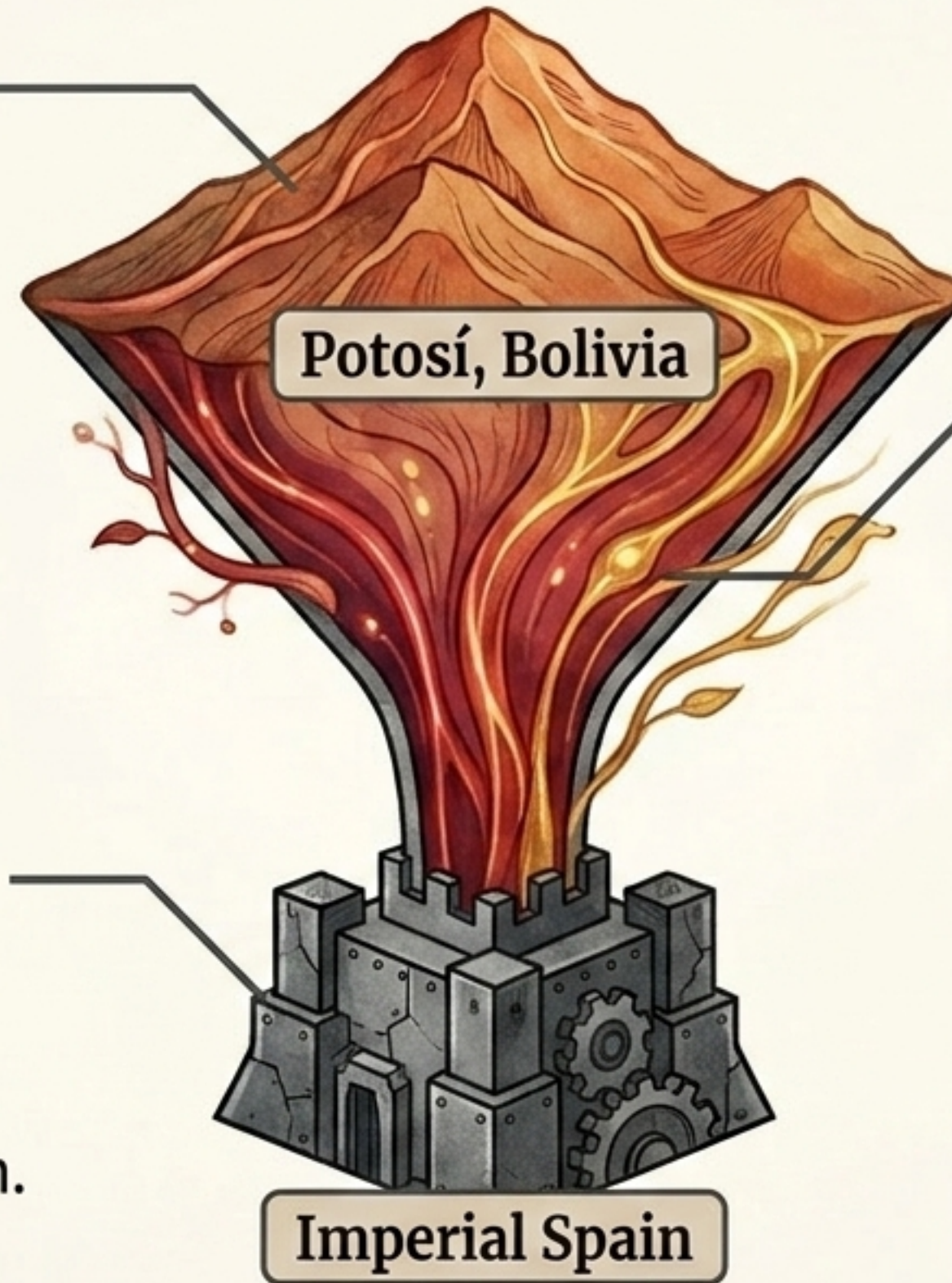
For 5,000 years, Europe was an isolated periphery



1492 marks the violent birth of the First Modernity

The True Center

1492 is the moment Europe finally bypasses the Islamic blockade and constitutes itself as the center of a new World-System.



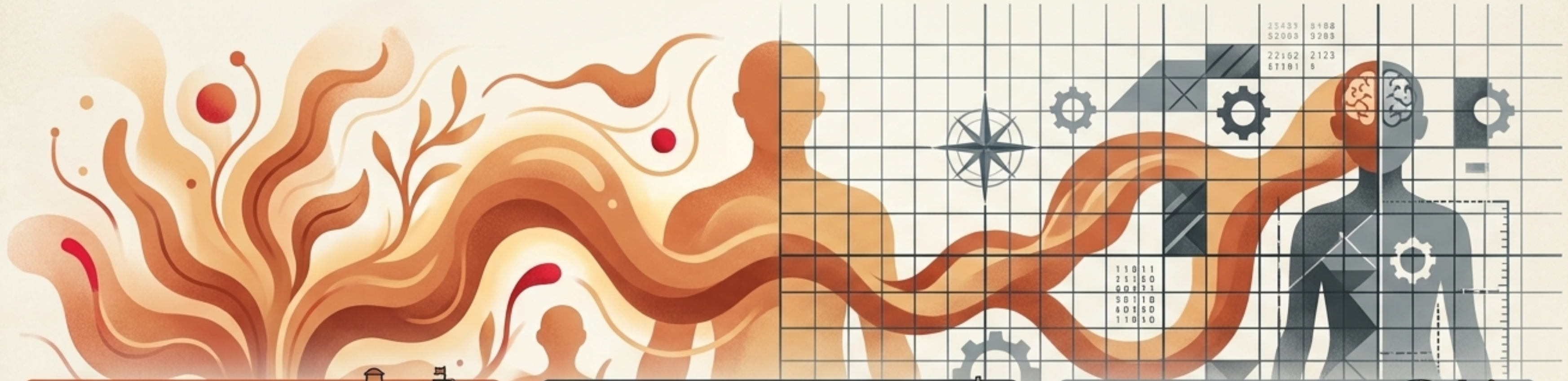
The First World Currency

18,000 tons of silver extracted from Potosí and Zacatecas create the first global monetary system.

The Birth of Bureaucracy

The Spanish Empire pioneers state bureaucracy to manage extraction, laying the material groundwork for global capitalism.

The Second Modernity simplifies human existence into calculation



The Place



Amsterdam, 1630

The birthplace of the East India Company.
A city with no desire to spread religion or culture, only to extract profit.

The Philosopher



René Descartes

He writes the *Discourse on the Method* in Amsterdam, creating Amsterdam, creating the philosophical justification for extraction.

The Ideology



Mind/Body Dualism

The human body, nature, and the suffering of the colonized are reduced to mere "objects" mere "objects" to be rationally calculated for the rate of profit.

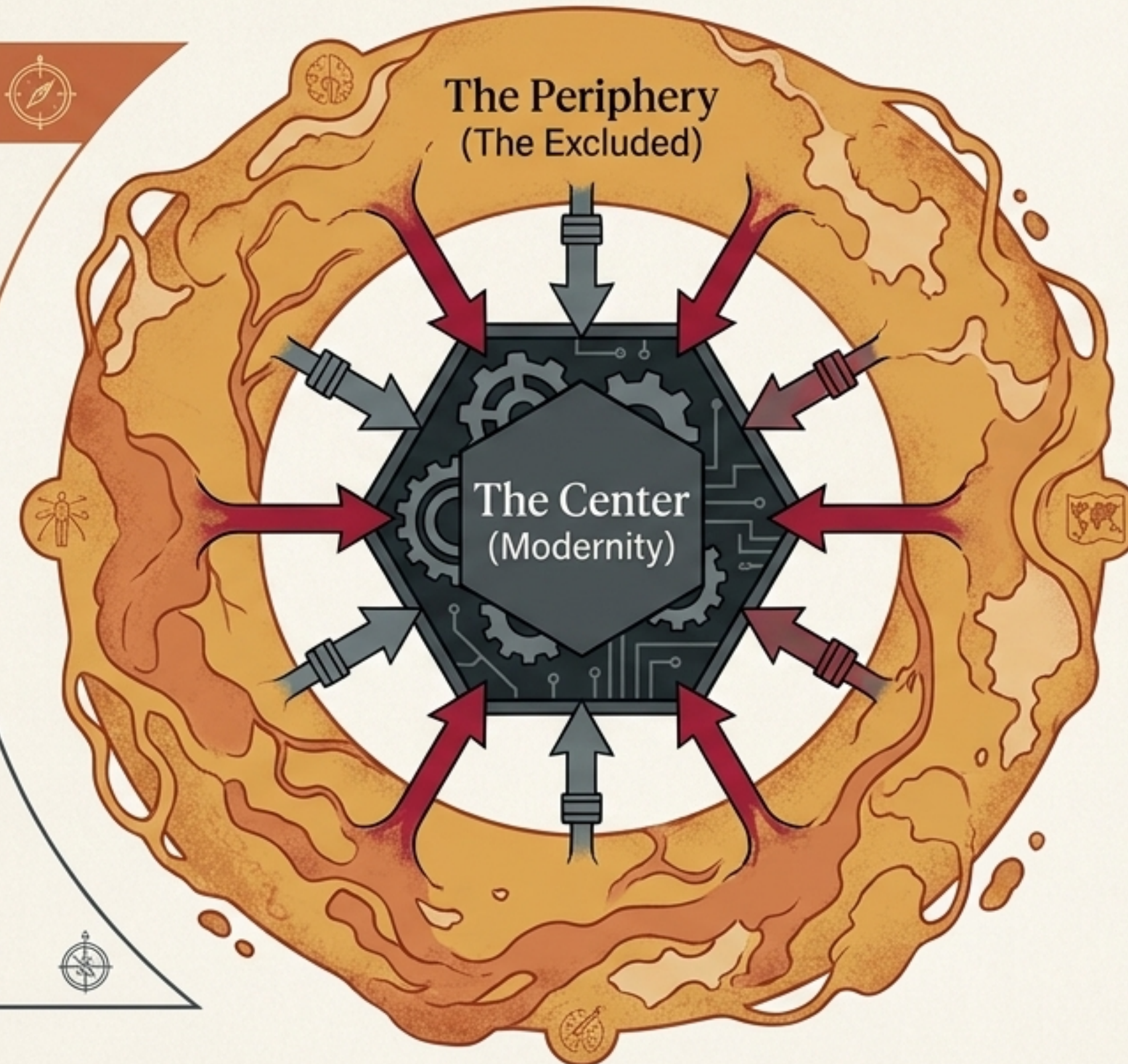
Modernity requires the invention of the 'barbarian'

The Core Logic

Modernity is not the spread of enlightenment; it is the violent management of global centrality.

The Requirement

For a center to exist, there must be a periphery. The wealth of the center mathematically requires the poverty of the outside.



The Exclusion

Modern economics formalizes this logic. It calculates inflation and interest, but fundamentally excludes the physical hunger of the human beings living in the periphery.

Dismantling the myth of the 'epistemological break'

Orthodox / Soviet Marxism

Believes in a total 'break' in Marx's thought in 1845.

Dismisses the "Young Marx" as a soft philosopher.

Views *Capital* as a purely economic, structuralist, and deterministic text.

Historically resulted in dogmatic state bureaucracy.

Dussel's Philosophy of Liberation

Proves absolute continuity from his youth to his death.

Views Marx fundamentally as a philosopher of ethics and life.

Reads *Capital* as an ethical critique of a system that destroys human corporeality.

Dussel spent 15 years reading Marx line-by-line, including unedited manuscripts from Amsterdam, to prove this absolute continuity.

The foundation of critique is the vulnerable human body

Against Hegel

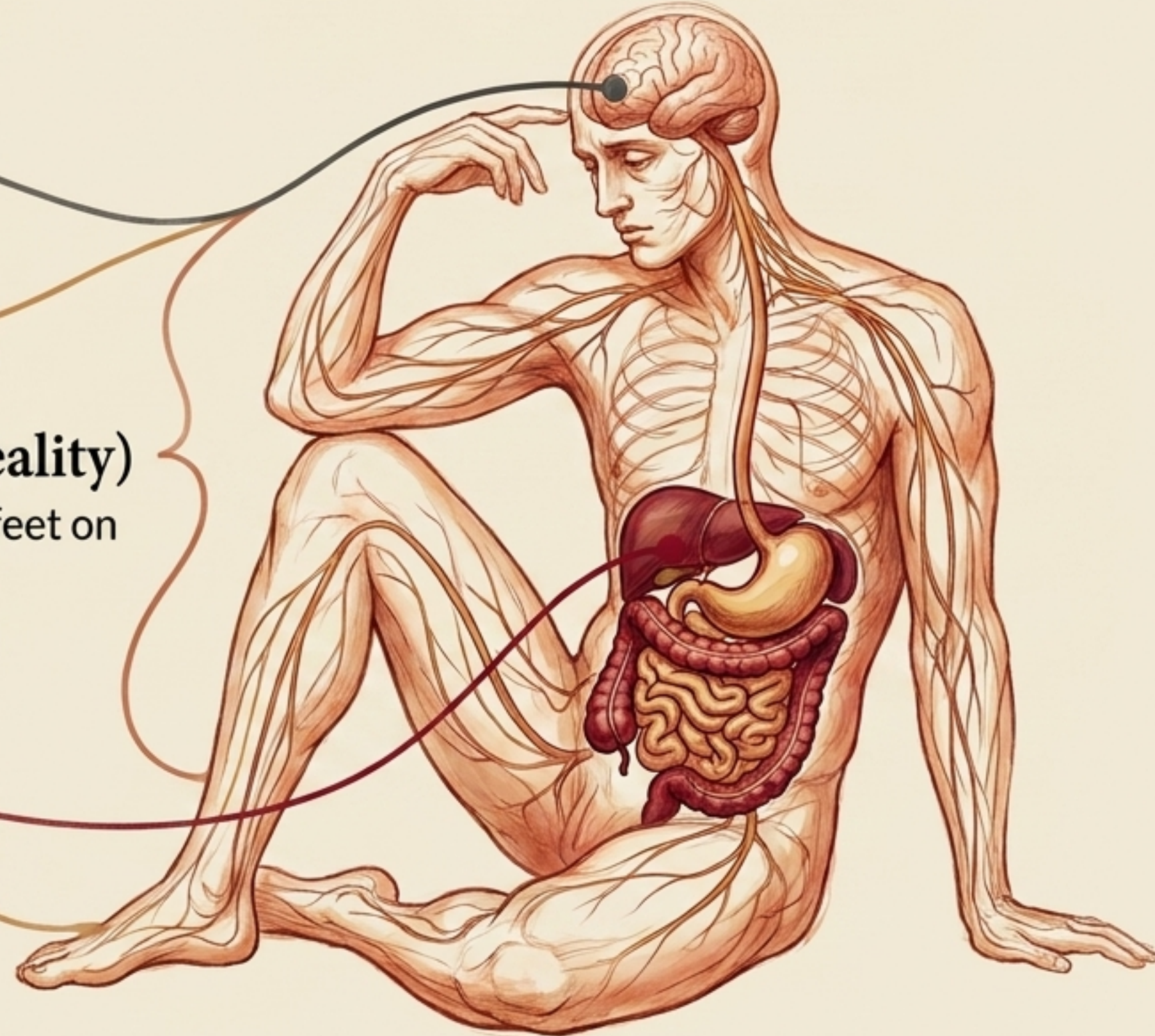
Hegel believed reality was pure self-consciousness. Marx recognized that the true meaning of 'material' is the physical, cosmic reality of the body.

Leiblichkeit (Corporeality)

The real human being with feet on the earth.

Leidendes (Suffering)

To be living is to be vulnerable. Basic natural necessities—eating, drinking, clothing, housing—are the absolute preconditions for any economy.



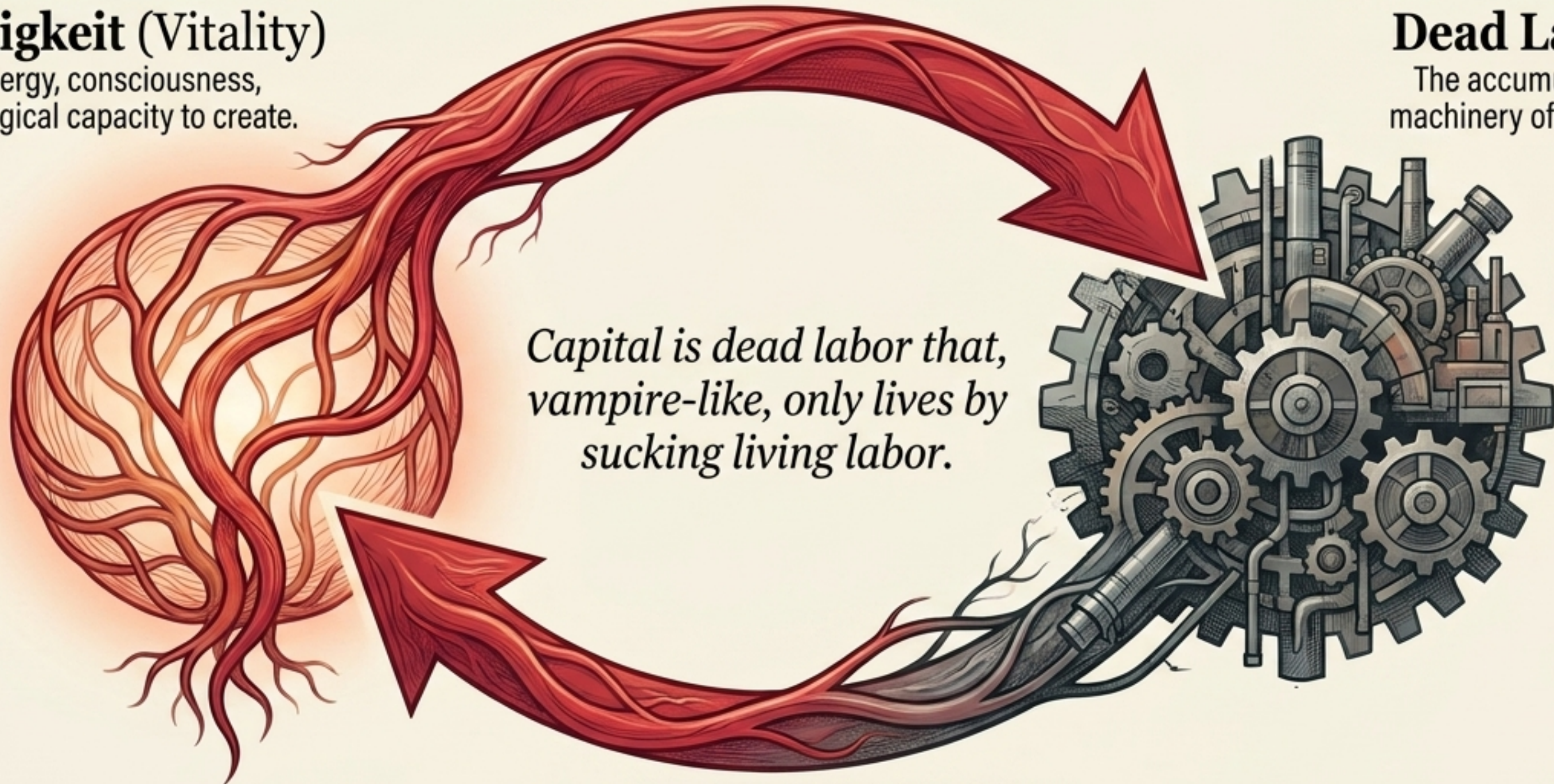
Capital operates as a vampire feeding on living vitality

Lebendigkeit (Vitality)

Human energy, consciousness,
and the biological capacity to create.

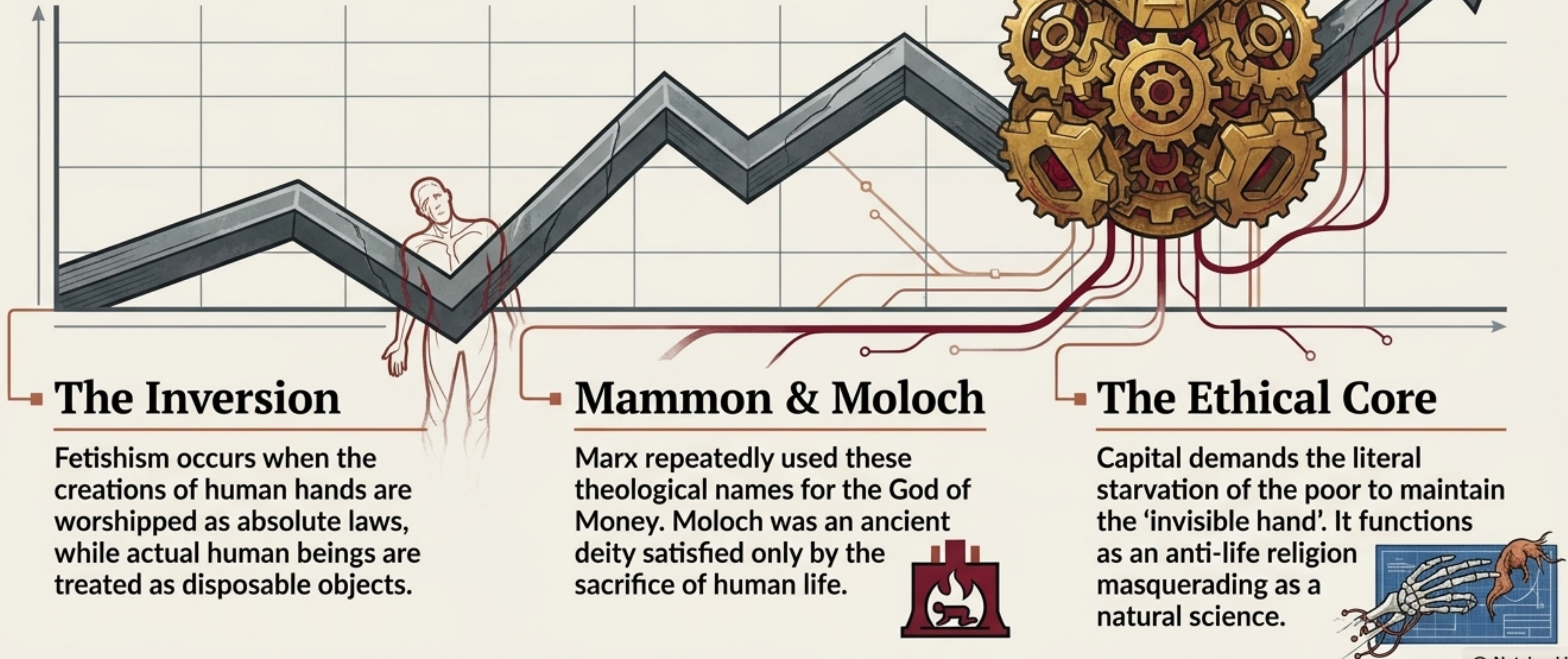
Dead Labor

The accumulated
machinery of Capital.

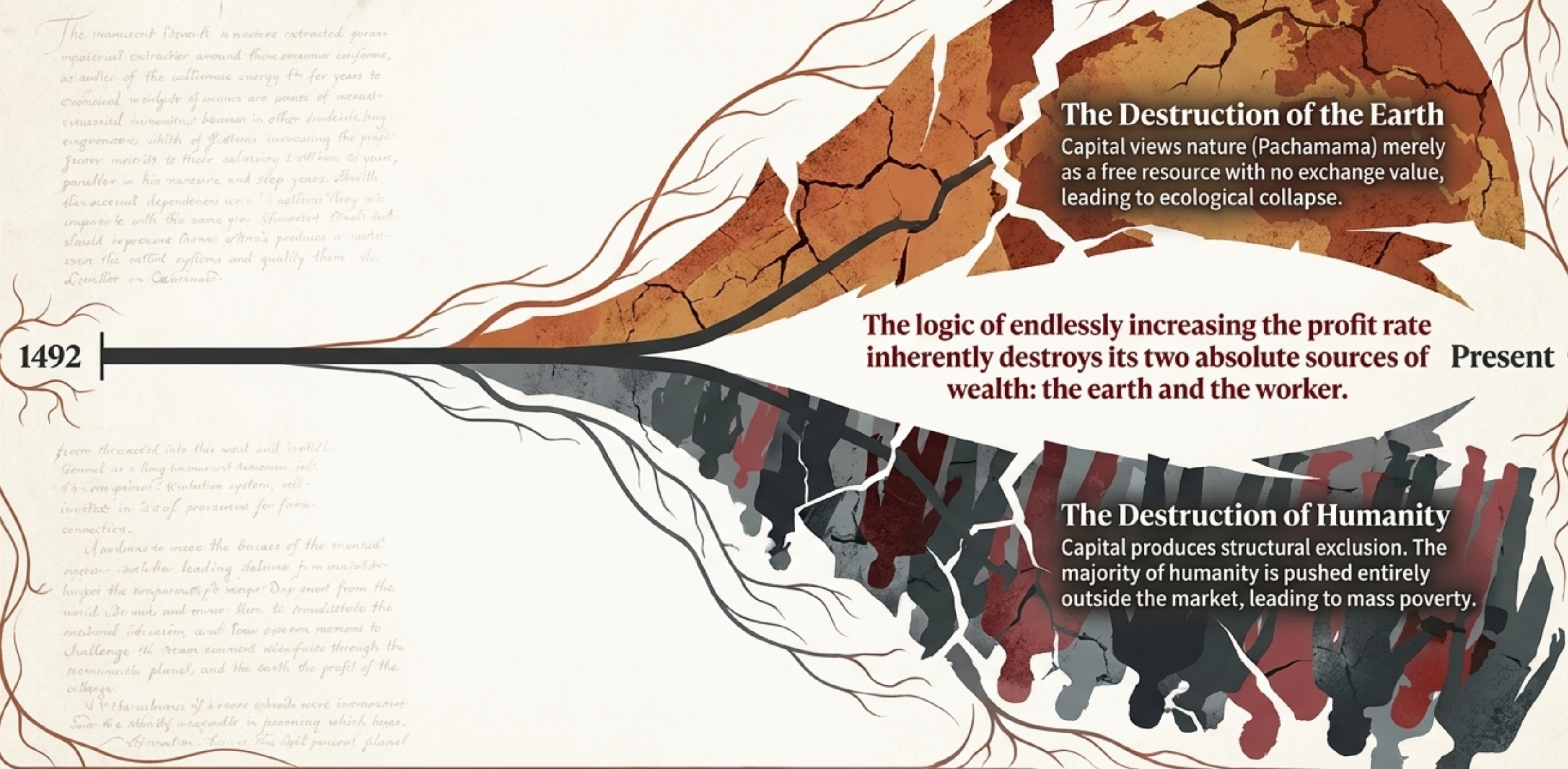


For Marx, economics is a dialectic of life and death.
The worker does not just sell time; they **objectify** and **sacrifice**
their **actual biological lifespan** into the product.

The fetishism of the market as an altar of human sacrifice



500 years of extraction inevitably produces two fatal crises



1492

The Destruction of the Earth

Capital views nature (Pachamama) merely as a free resource with no exchange value, leading to ecological collapse.

The logic of endlessly increasing the profit rate inherently destroys its two absolute sources of wealth: the earth and the worker. Present

The Destruction of Humanity

Capital produces structural exclusion. The majority of humanity is pushed entirely outside the market, leading to mass poverty.

The most vital framework for the 21st century

Beyond Neoliberalism

We cannot solve the crises of ecology and poverty using the exact categorical system (Eurocentric capitalism) that caused them.

The Standpoint of the Excluded

True ethical critique is only possible from the exteriority of the system —from the perspective of the poor, the marginalized, and the Global South.

Affirmation of Life

Marx remains essential because his ultimate project was not state bureaucracy, but the liberation of human corporeality and the defense of absolute life against the machinery machinery of death.